Part 1: Search Methodology and Ranking Justification

Largest 20 environment startups in India. Data collected 17 to 19 October 2026.

1. Search methodology

1. **Definition.** An environment startup here means a venture-backed company in the "Clean Tech" category: electric mobility, batteries and charging, renewables, carbon and emissions technology, and waste and circular economy.
2. **Candidate universe.** Inc42 Datalabs' "Top 30 Funded Cleantech Startups In India 2026", which ranks companies by total funding raised. Positions 1 to 25 were retrievable. Inc42 counts about 2,800 cleantech startups, of which about 460 are funded.
3. **Cross-check for gaps.** Tracxn's India climate-tech data (as reported by Entrepreneur India), Seedtable's cleantech rankings and a 2026 climate-tech roundup were scanned for companies the Inc42 tag misses, mainly in waste, carbon and water. One company was added from this check: Chakr Innovation (about $65.7M, from businessconnectindia.in).
4. **Candidate pool.** 24 companies, as listed in the startup spreadsheet. Funding figures are cumulative disclosed funding in USD (equity plus debt), taken from Inc42 unless the Source column says otherwise.

2. Ranking justification

Eligibility. ReNew Energy and Gensol Engineering were excluded as large listed companies (ReNew is a utility-scale power producer funded mostly by debt; Gensol is a listed engineering company that Inc42's profile tags as an investor). The other 22 companies were ranked.

Method A, funding. Companies were ranked by total funding raised, highest first.

Method B, scale (cross-check). Companies were ranked by employee headcount, highest first. Funding alone favours asset-heavy or debt-funded companies, and headcount balances this by reflecting operating scale.

Final rank. The average of the Method A and Method B ranks, ranked from lowest to highest. Ties go to the company with more funding. The top 20 final ranks make the list. The same logic is in the spreadsheet as formulas, so a change to any input updates the ranks.

3. Result

Final rank	Startup	Category	Funding (USD M)	Employees	Funding rank (A)	Headcount rank (B)
1	Ola Electric	EV & charging	1,500.0	8,996	1	1
2	ACME Solar	Solar & clean energy	1,250.0	3,158	2	3
3	Ather Energy	EV & charging	574.3	4,544	3	2
4	Euler Motors	EV & charging	376.9	1,588	5	5
5	Battery Smart	EV & charging	228.1	1,155	8	7
6	Simple Energy	EV & charging	290.5	673	6	12
7	River	EV & charging	188.0	1,174	12	6
8	SolarSquare	Solar & clean energy	113.2	2,924	14	4
9	Bounce	EV & charging	238.1	637	7	13
10	SUN Mobility	EV & charging	135.0	959	13	9
11	Ultraviolette Automotive	EV & charging	220.9	586	9	15
12	Agratas	Energy storage	113.1	901	15	10
13	EKA Mobility	EV & charging	103.9	1,113	17	8
14	EV Co	EV & charging	463.9	50	4	22

Final rank	Startup	Category	Funding (USD M)	Employees	Funding rank (A)	Headcount rank (B)
15	Matter	EV & charging	88.0	754	18	11
16	Ecozen Solutions	Solar & clean energy	107.4	620	16	14
17	Smartron	EV & charging	200.0	84	10	21
18	Carbon Clean Solutions	Carbon & emissions	190.6	188	11	20
19	Chakr Innovation	Carbon & emissions	65.7	427	20	17
20	ChargeZone	EV & charging	86.1	213	19	19

Just outside the top 20: Recykal (21st) and Exponent Energy (22nd).

4. Limitations

1. **Electric mobility dominates.** The funding-based universe is EV-heavy, so waste, water and carbon startups are under-represented.
2. **Funding includes debt and is unaudited.** Inc42 and Tracxn totals differ. Ola Electric's most recent round is listed as debt financing, so its total includes debt.
3. **Some entries do not fit the startup definition cleanly.** ACME Solar (founded 2003, listed), Agratas (a Tata Sons subsidiary), EV Co (a single corporate-style round; ownership inferred, not confirmed) and Smartron (consumer electronics and IoT) were kept because they meet the funding and headcount rule, but they are not typical venture-backed environment startups. Ola Electric and Ather Energy are now listed companies and were retained as new-age companies.
4. **Headcount favours labour-heavy firms** and is lower for EV Co (50) and Smartron (84) than their funding suggests.
5. **One company is headquartered abroad:** Carbon Clean Solutions (London, with Mumbai operations), which is India-origin.
6. **Data gaps.** Inc42 positions 26 to 30 were not retrievable, and Chakr's funding comes from a single secondary source. Headquarters cities and websites not tied to a cited source come from general knowledge and should be verified.